

KITCHEN EXTRACT CLEANING

What the guidance says, and how often to clean

1. WHAT GOVERNMENT GUIDANCE SAYS

- The Home Office guide **Fire safety risk assessment: small and medium places of assembly** lists cooking equipment, hot ducting, flues and filters as ignition sources, and names grease build-up on catering extraction equipment as a common cause of fire. It is written for places such as pubs, clubs and halls.
- It says cooking and catering equipment should be installed, used, maintained and protected following the manufacturer's instructions.
- It gives **no cleaning interval** for extract ducting and "does not set prescriptive standards". The frequency comes from your fire risk assessment and the industry specification below.
- London Fire Brigade advises regular cleaning of kitchen ducting to avoid grease build-up. Its guidance note GN86 refers operators to TR/19® Grease and sets **annual cleaning as the minimum** for catering kitchen extract systems, unless your fire risk assessment recommends otherwise.

2. HOW OFTEN? THE TR/19® GREASE USAGE SCALE

TR/19® Grease, published by the Building Engineering Services Association (BESA), sets minimum cleaning intervals by how many hours a day the kitchen cooks.

Level of use	Hours cooking per day	Clean the extract system every
Heavy	12 to 16 hours	3 months
Moderate	6 to 12 hours	6 months
Light	2 to 6 hours	12 months

- Grease between cleans must not exceed a **mean of 200 microns (0.2 mm)**, about half the thickness of a business card, measured with a wet film thickness gauge. Ask your contractor for readings before and after each clean.
- Fat frying, wood or charcoal cooking may need cleaning more often. Check your buildings insurer's requirements too.

WORK OUT YOUR LEVEL

Hours the kitchen cooks each day: _____ Level: ☐ Heavy ☐ Moderate ☐ Light

Date of last extract clean: _____ Certificate seen: ☐ Yes ☐ No

3. SOURCES: SCAN OR CLICK TO READ THE ORIGINALS



Home Office (GOV.UK)
[Small and medium places of assembly guide](#)



London Fire Brigade
[Takeaways, cafés and restaurants](#)



London Fire Brigade GN86
[Catering kitchen extract systems \(PDF\)](#)



BESA
[Kitchen extract cleaning and TR/19® Grease](#)

Information checked on 10 October 2026. Guidance and web links can change, so check the originals for the latest version. Also used: Norfolk Fire and Rescue Service, Kitchen extraction systems. The TR/19® Grease scale and 200 micron limit are as published on BESA's website; check the TR/19® Grease guide itself for full detail. General information only; it does not replace a fire risk assessment of your premises.